METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Electronic Waste Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Electronic Waste Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Electronic Waste is a Key Issue in the Environmental Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on their production of electronic waste, their potential exposure to electronic waste regulations and their efforts at product collection and recycling.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	**Electronic Waste**
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Loss of access to markets due to regulatory change.
- Loss of revenue due to changing consumer demand.
- Increased costs due to compliance with producer responsibility regulations.

Electronic Waste Key Issue score

The Electronic Waste Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score on this Key Issue is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Electronic Waste Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Electronic Waste Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the

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company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

Component	Sustainability Indicator
Electronic Waste Practices score	Scope of the electronic waste take-back program by product type
	Scope of the electronic waste take-back program by location
	Scope of electronic waste take-back programs
	Facilities that handle recycling of collected electronics
	Explicit ban on electronic waste exports to non-OECD countries
Electronic Waste Performance score	End of life electronic waste recycling

Electronic Waste Management score

The Electronic Waste Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Electronic Waste Management score Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

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$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Electronic Waste Practices score

The Electronic Waste Practices score evaluates the company's ability to manage risks related to electronic-waste generation, product take-back and recycling programs. This score considers attributes of the company's policies and initiatives. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Scope of the electronic waste take-back program by product type**

Definition: The scope of products that are eligible for collection and recycling under the company's electronic waste product recycling program.

- **Scope of the electronic waste take-back program by location**

Definition: The geographic scope of the company's product collection and electronic waste recycling program.

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- **Scope of electronic waste take-back programs**

Definition: Assesses the company's return channels for end-of-life products - drop-off, mail-in, and pick-up. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

  - **Electronic waste take-back programs include drop-off of end-of-life products**
    Definition: Indicates whether channels for consumers to return end-of-life electronics to the company include drop-off options (at a store or designated drop-off locations).

  - **Electronic waste take-back programs include mail-in of end-of-life products**
    Definition: Indicates whether available channels for consumers to return end-of-life electronics to the company include mail-in options.

  - **Electronic waste take-back programs include pick-up of end-of-life products**
    Definition: Indicates whether available channels for consumers to return end-of-life electronics to the company include pick-up options.

  - **Electronic waste take-back program exists but no details given**
    Definition Indicates whether channels exist for consumers to return end-of-life electronics to the company, but details are not provided.

- **Facilities that handle recycling of collected electronics**

  Definition: Assesses company efforts in managing electronic waste through recycling. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

  - **Company-operated electronic waste recycling facilities**
    Definition: Indicates whether the company operates its own electronic waste recycling facilities. The company may also use vendors or participate in recycling management organizations for electronic waste recycling.

  - **Participation in electronic waste recycling programs**
    Definition: Indicates that the company participates in electronic waste (e-waste) recycling management organizations (or recycling consortia/network) that support or operate recycling facilities. The company may also operate its own facilities or use vendors for e-waste recycling.

  - **Vendor-operated electronic waste recycling facilities**
    Definition: Indicates that the company uses designated vendors that operate electronic waste (e-waste) recycling facilities. The company may also operate its own facilities or participate in recycling management organizations for e-waste recycling. Moreover, indicates whether these vendors audited or certified by the company or third-party audit programs (including but not limited to R2, e-stewards and WEEELABEX).

  - **Unspecified electronic waste recycling activities**

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Definition: Indicates that the company has a general statement on recycling electronic waste (e-waste) with no further details regarding the facilities, vendors or organizations that handle recycling of collected e-waste.

- **Explicit ban on electronic waste exports to non-OECD countries**

Definition: Indicates whether the company explicitly bans electronic waste exports from OECD member countries to non-OECD member countries for disposal and recovery, in accordance with the Basel Ban Amendment to the Basel Convention.

Electronic Waste Performance score

The Electronic Waste Performance score evaluates the company's performance on electronic waste management metrics (including recycling of electronic waste). It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **End of life electronic waste recycling**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the share of electronic waste that is recovered and subsequently recycled by the company. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong performance.

  - **Percentage of electronic waste recycled – Reported**
    Definition: Indicates the proportion of collected end-of-life electronic waste that is successfully recycled and repurposed relative to the total end-of-life products and e-waste recovered.

Sources: Company disclosures, Silicon Valley Toxics Coalition, Basel Action Network, GoodElectronics, Greenpeace's Greener Electronics reports.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Electronic waste controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

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Electronic Waste Exposure score

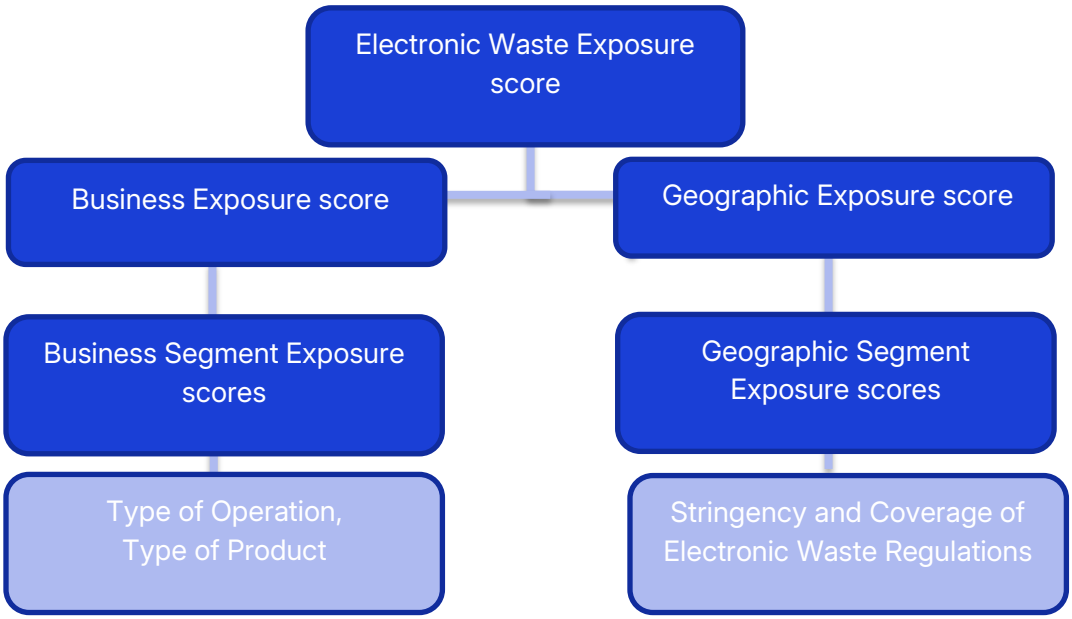
The Electronic Waste Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Geographic Exposure scores. The Geographic Exposure score functions as a multiplier on the Business Exposure score, with an impact ranging from -50% to +50%. The Business and Geographic Exposure scores are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following data sources and methodologies are used in the Exposure score calculation:

$$EXP_{ELW,i} = BUS_{ELW,i}(1 + 0.1(GEO_{ELW,i} - 5))$$

Where:

- $EXP_{ELW,i}$ is the Electronic Waste Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{ELW,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $GEO_{ELW,i}$ is the Geographic Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



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Business Segment Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each business segment, using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{ELW,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,j} BSE_{ELW,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{ELW,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure scores

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is determined by a weighted average of the Type of Operations score and Type of Product score:

$$BSE_{ELW,j} = 0.35\left(TOO_{ELW,j}\right) + 0.65(TOP_{ELW,j})$$

Where:

- $TOO_{ELW,j}$ is the Type of Operations score for business activity j.
- $TOP_{ELW,j}$ is the Type of Product score for business activity j.

The Type of Operations score is assessed as a qualitative assessment of whether the type of operations of a business activity involves the manufacture and/or sale of electronic equipment and devices.

The Type of Product score is assessed as a qualitative assessment of whether the product category of the business activity involves the manufacture and/or sale of electronic equipment and devices. The product categories considered are consumer electronics, office electronics, household appliances and professional equipment.

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Geographic Exposure score

The Geographic Exposure score is a weighted average of the Geographic Segment Exposure scores of the countries,markets and regions in which the company operates. scores are weighted by the proportion of the company's total revenue in each geographic segment through the following equation:

$$GEO_{ELW,i} = \sum_{r=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,r} GSE_{ELW,r}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{ELW,r}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score in region r.
- $w_{Revenue,i,r}$ is the weight of region r for company i based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of geographic segments for company i.

For geographic segments disclosed as regions (example: Asia Pacific), a nominal GDP-weighted country or market aggregation is used to calculate region-level scores, using the following equation:

$$GSE_{ELW,r} = \sum_{c=1}^{n_r} w_{GDP,r,c} GSE_{ELW,c}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{ELW,c}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of country or market c.
- $w_{GDP,r,c}$ is the specific weight of country or market c within region r.

Geographic Segment Exposure scores

The Geographic Segment Exposure score is determined by a qualitative framework to assess countries or markets with strengthening or evolving electronic waste regulations. Higher regulation standards and wider coverage result in a higher risk exposure score for a given country or market.

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Electronic Waste Exposure score:

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